

Aaron Amerling

Marketing, Product & Innovation Executive

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Marketing and product executive who identifies shifts in technology, culture, and consumer behavior before they become obvious, then builds the brand, product, or team to meet that moment. Early advisor to GoFundMe when it was three people around a table, contributing to the positioning that became the crowdfunding category. Helped lead GreatCall's shift from a telecom company into a mobile health pioneer. Background spans in-house marketing and product leadership, agency executive roles, early-stage advisory work, and hands-on applied AI.

WHAT I BRING

- **Growth with numbers attached.** £40M+ annual paid budgets. Grew one digital budget from \$250K/year to tens of millions annually. 400% sales increase with CPA cut two-thirds. Inbound MQLs from ~10/year to 100+/month. 50% conversion lift and 80% ARPU increase. Two #1 Medical-category apps; 25,000 to 1.5M users.
- **AI in marketing, applied.** Led product and development for VoxDirect, a small business text marketing platform built with AI chat ahead of the category. Deployed AEO and GEO as live growth channels, rolled generative AI workflows across marketing organizations, and launched AI consumer-facing products. Builds and ships in the tooling directly, including agentic multi-tool systems and prototype products. Techstars mentor to AI founders.
- **Research, pricing and conversion.** Commissioned and ran a \$1M audience research study with Nielsen, including focus groups and interviews. Price elasticity testing that raised average order value. CRO and multivariate testing programs on owned web properties.
- **People management and org design.** Ran a 60-person department across paid, owned, earned, strategy and client services, restructured around SME development and retention. Led teams across three continents. Managed 14 agencies and vendors.
- **Technology fluency and forward calls.** Co-inventor on five U.S. patents for a trust-network architecture. Founded a blockchain division and invented a utility-token telecom platform. Read crowdfunding, mobile health, AEO and AI digital twins early.

STRATEGIC ADVISORY & INNOVATION

GoFundMe | *Early Marketing Advisor*

- Worked with founders during early concept development (then "Create-A-Fund"), when the company was three people around a table, contributing to the positioning that became social crowdfunding. Served as the company's first marketing advisor, training its initial marketing hire and managing its first agency.

Steno.ai | *Strategic Advisor / Techstars Mentor*

- Provided brand strategy and product-market fit guidance for an AI "digital twin" venture (Techstars '23), and mentor other early-stage AI founders through the Techstars network. Identified the use case for AI-based digital cloning in the influencer and expert markets, and led the engagement that secured Tony Robbins as the flagship customer.

Cloudhands (cloudhands.ai) | *Product & AI Consultant*

- Consultant to an AI venture, building internal applications and prototype products and developing reusable orchestrations for generative creative production.

TrendSource | *Strategic Marketing Advisor*

- Repositioned a market research firm and rebuilt go-to-market strategy, growing inbound MQLs from roughly 10 per year to 100+ per month and driving Fortune 10 enterprise demand with content and SEO that outranked incumbents including Nielsen. Built the content program around original quarterly research studies and case studies cited by major newspapers and national organizations, earning press including The New York Times and NPR. Ran automated lifecycle email with logic-flow journeys in HubSpot, and managed the sales team against its number.

American Medical Response (AMR) | *Crisis & Search Strategy Advisor*

- Architected an SEO and PR positioning campaign for the publicly traded leader in emergency medical services, reclaiming first-page search visibility and positive social sentiment.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Amerling Group | San Diego, CA / Remote

Fractional CMO & Growth Advisor | *May 2026 - Present*

- Retained by a global consulting firm to bring its marketing leadership onto AEO and GEO and into generative AI workflows, preparing the organization for zero-click search.
- Brand definition, positioning and go-to-market strategy for venture-backed startups.
- Builds and ships applied AI systems, including agentic multi-tool workflows and prototype products spanning e-commerce, social and internal enterprise applications.

Etna Interactive | San Luis Obispo, CA / Remote

Chief Marketing Officer | *May 2024 - April 2026*

- Led a 60-person marketing organization spanning paid, owned, earned, strategy and client services, serving healthcare clients under HIPAA compliance requirements.
- Restructured the department around subject-matter-expert development and retention, building a durable senior bench in a high-churn agency market.
- Pioneered Answer Engine Optimization (AEO) and Generative Engine Optimization (GEO) as new growth channels ahead of the category.
- Spearheaded generative AI programs for workflow efficiency and new AI consumer-facing products.
- Built client media strategies spanning paid search, paid social, programmatic and CTV, and produced the sales and event collateral behind them.
- Reconfigured the paid media fee structure to increase profitability while lowering perceived cost to prospective clients.

The Lemonade Agency | San Francisco / Remote

Vice President of Strategy | *March 2022 - April 2024*

- Oversaw marketing strategy for clients in gaming, technology, entertainment, Web3, AI and metaverse, including Disney, Meta, Square Enix, Ubisoft, Dior, DirecTV and the San Francisco Marathon.
- Developed and mentored a team of social, paid media, data analytics and influencer managers, plus blockchain and gaming subject matter experts.
- Developed Dior's strategy for integrating NFTs and crypto into the brand; shaped Ubisoft's go-to-market approach for new game launches; contributed to Disney campaign strategy.
- Built Disney's event strategy for a new game launch, and led brand presence at Comic-Con and major gaming industry events.
- Reversed years of decline for the San Francisco Marathon through new branding, customer focus and the email and social campaigns I ran, driving record turnout.

- Launched a video game campaign with 1,500% social growth and 6x download conversion (Apple featured app), generating 3M+ views and 100k+ clicks via a nonendemic influencer strategy.

Team Lewis | Remote

Interim Managing Director, US Digital | *September 2021 - March 2022*

- Led full agency teams for multiple clients including Fortune 100 technology companies and top cryptocurrency brands, including VMware and Ripple Labs.
- Ran combined PR, social and paid media strategy, landing regular national press for enterprise clients.
- Wrote scopes of work and managed client contracts worth millions of dollars per month.

Telcentris / Voxox (Cloudphone) | San Diego, CA

Director of Marketing and Product Innovation | *February 2017 - July 2021*

- Led marketing for a full suite of B2B and B2C telecom and SaaS cloud services, driving a 50% increase in conversion and an 80% increase in ARPU.
- Led product and development for VoxDirect, a small business text marketing platform built with AI chat ahead of the category, plus drip campaign automation, logic-flow builders and virtual phone system integration.
- Owned the company website end to end, running conversion rate optimization with A/B and multivariate testing in Optimizely and Hotjar.
- Ran price elasticity testing and restructured pricing and packaging, raising average order value.
- Led ideation, research and product marketing for new products based on future industry trends, creating a product that drew interest from global carriers, and owned go-to-market, launch and industry event presence for the portfolio.
- Founded a new blockchain division building distributed applications for telecommunications, and invented a novel utility token-based telecom platform.

GAIN Credit | San Diego / London / Chennai, India

Senior Manager of Digital Product & Marketing | *January 2016 - February 2017*

- Managed a £40M+ annual digital marketing budget (approximately \$50M) across PPC, display and affiliate channels for the regulated consumer lending brands Lending Stream and Drafty, driving the company's highest-ever paid search revenues.
- Ran a team across San Diego, London and Chennai, turning it into the top-performing sales channel within 6 months.
- Developed product marketing strategy for a new lending brand that won New Fintech Product of the Year at the Fintech Awards.

Best Buy Health (formerly GreatCall) | San Diego, CA

Senior Manager of Digital & Mobile Product and Marketing | *January 2012 - January 2016*

- Grew the digital marketing budget from \$250,000 per year to tens of millions annually on the strength of performance, increasing sales 400% while cutting CPA by roughly two-thirds within a single year.
- Built and ran the company's first agile mobile apps product team, launching two #1 Medical-category apps (App Store, Google Play), growing mobile users from 25,000 to over 1.5 million, and leading the company's CES presence built around that launch.
- Ran paid, owned and earned across paid search, display, CTV, Amazon Ads, broadcast television, SEO, email, social and affiliate; launched the company's first SEO and affiliate strategy, doubling organic traffic and lifting affiliate sales 500%.
- Commissioned and ran a \$1M audience research study with Nielsen, using focus groups and interviews to define the company's core demographics and inform product and positioning.
- Owned digital properties and conversion testing; managed direct reports plus 14 agencies, vendors and contractors in a HIPAA-compliant environment.
- Created GreatCall Labs, an internal innovation team that was awarded multiple patents and developed new product lines that became company flagship products.

Early Career: Marketing communications leadership at Robbins Research International (Tony Robbins) and Ziff Davis / J2 Global, including a record-breaking holiday sales campaign (\$1M+ in 10 days, 200% YoY) and an automated email upsell program generating \$1M+ in incremental monthly revenue across 14 international brands; presented to the board of Ziff Davis, a publicly traded company, on creative strategy. Earlier product marketing and pricing work at KidZui, a consumer technology startup, including price elasticity testing that raised average order value. Also: TV Writer for Nickelodeon's Avatar: The Last Airbender, Writer for Tony Robbins, and Associate Producer for E! Entertainment's Child Star Confidential.

PATENTS & RECOGNITION

- Co-inventor, five U.S. patents for a trust-network architecture, originally built for emergency response call centers and written broadly enough to cover authentication, identity verification, and influence targeting; assigned to GreatCall / Best Buy Health.
- Runner-up, CONNECT Most Innovative Product of the Year (Mobile Apps) | International Communicator Award | Three International Telly Awards, Digital Advertising
- Nickelodeon Fellowship Recipient | 20th Century Fox New Writers Award | Published author
- Speaker, mHealth Conference, plus marketing and search industry conferences and podcasts

CORE SKILLS

Marketing strategy & leadership | Go-to-market & product strategy | Product marketing & positioning | Demand generation & ABM | Brand storytelling & positioning | Customer & market research | Pricing & packaging | Conversion rate optimization & A/B testing | Applied AI (AEO/GEO, generative AI workflows, agentic systems, stack automation) | Full-stack paid, owned & earned | PR & earned media | Org design & team building | B2B, B2C, direct and social selling | Regulated industries (HIPAA, consumer lending)

TOOLS & PLATFORMS

HubSpot | Salesforce | Google Ads | Meta Ads | Microsoft Advertising | Google Analytics 4 | Semrush | Ahrefs | Optimizely | Google Optimize | Hotjar | Mailchimp | Constant Contact | Asana | Monday.com | Jira | Basecamp | Tableau | Claude | Claude Code | ChatGPT | Replit | Zapier | HeyGen | Sora | Kling | Seedance

CERTIFICATIONS

HubSpot Certified | Google Ads Certified | Google Analytics 4 Certified

EDUCATION

University of California, Santa Cruz | B.A. in History
San Diego State University | M.A. in Digital Media, TV and Film